

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 508

By Barrett

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend The Elephant Sanctuary of Tennessee on the occasion of its thirtieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, located in Hohenwald, The Elephant Sanctuary of Tennessee is the largest sanctuary in North America providing refuge and care for elephants in need; and

WHEREAS, since 1995, The Elephant Sanctuary of Tennessee has provided refuge for elephants who have retired from performance and exhibition; now encompassing more than 3,060 acres and three separate and protected natural habitats, the Sanctuary is home to a dozen elephant residents, with room for more; and

WHEREAS, the success and continued growth of The Elephant Sanctuary is due in large part to the dedication and hard work of two individuals who have contributed significantly to its mission, namely Lois C. Knight and Dr. William Schaffner; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Knight has been a part of The Elephant Sanctuary since its inception, serving in multiple capacities as a volunteer, liaison, and key contributor to community outreach and fundraising efforts; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Schaffner has served as an advisor to The Elephant Sanctuary since 1995 and as a board member since 2007, sharing his expertise and leadership in the field of infectious diseases and health; his advocacy for the best medical care for elephants in human care and for science-based protection for elephant caretakers has shaped the facility's health and safety protocols; and

WHEREAS, today, the Sanctuary employs fifty staff in Lewis County, who work to provide home, herd, rest, refuge, and individualized care for life to the elephants who have spent years performing in circuses and educating the public in zoos; and

WHEREAS, the Sanctuary is a boon for this rural Tennessee area, providing not only career and internship opportunities but also volunteer experiences; the Sanctuary's Discovery Center offers hands-on, self-guided exhibits and educational programming for families, schools, and other interested parties, as well as distance learning online; and

WHEREAS, at The Sanctuary, elephants have the opportunity to live in expansive and diverse habitats in the rolling hills of Tennessee, which allow for a range of vegetation for foraging, enrichment, and natural behaviors; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend The Elephant Sanctuary of Tennessee on the occasion of its thirtieth anniversary, applauding its continuing efforts to provide a safe haven and natural habitat dedicated solely to elephant well-being.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.